

WPR181 Gorup Project

Group-181 P-13

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For the home page, I built a full-bleed hero section (`.main-statement`) with a background image, a semi-transparent dark overlay for text contrast, and a flexbox nav absolutely positioned on top of it so the logo and links sit directly over the photo. Below that, the "Category strip" is a flexbox row of four tiles, each combining an image, heading, and a bordered "View" button that fills solid on hover via a simple background-color transition. For the About page, I switched to a two-column split layout (`.section.split`) using flexbox to place the portrait image and bio copy side by side, with a light-background nav variant (`.site_nav_onlight`) since there's no dark hero image to sit on top of. Typography across both pages pairs Cormorant Garamond for headings with Lato for body/UI text, imported via Google Fonts, and the color palette is built around warm neutrals defined as repeated hex values in the stylesheet.

Shiluva Mnukwa 915174

My main contribution to the project was leading the JavaScript extension for our site, including researching and deciding on the specific effects we wanted — a scroll-triggered zoom/fade on the hero image, a staggered reveal animation for the category tiles, and a click-to-enlarge lightbox gallery for the photo pages. I sourced reference examples of similar effects on real photography portfolios to guide the design decisions. Throughout development, I tested every change directly in the browser and used the DevTools Console, Elements, and Sources tabs to diagnose issues as they came up, including tracking down a missing script tag, several CSS/JavaScript class-name mismatches, and an unsaved-file issue that were each causing the animations to silently fail. I also made structural decisions such as renaming the homepage file to `index.html` to follow standard web conventions, and I built out the four category gallery pages (Candid, Portraits, Nature, Editorial) following a consistent template once the first one was working correctly. I sourced and organised the photography used across the category pages. Once the core JavaScript features were implemented and fully working, I made the decision to stop adding further, more advanced functionality, since our module hadn't formally covered JavaScript yet and I wanted to be able to fully understand and explain any code included in our submission rather than include anything I couldn't confidently walk through myself.

Mndeni Simelane 606847

My main contribution to the project was designing and styling the portfolio gallery page. This included researching and selecting the visual approach for the gallery, which consisted of a full-bleed grid layout with a large feature image, portrait-cropped thumbnails, and captions that appear when the user hovers over an image rather than remaining visible at all times. I researched examples of photography portfolio websites to guide these design decisions, particularly how asymmetric grid layouts and hover-reveal captions can create a clean and modern user experience.

I implemented *the .portfolio_gallery* using CSS Grid with three equal columns. I then used the grid-column and grid-row properties with the *.portfolio_large* and *.portfolio_wide* classes to allow selected images to occupy larger areas of the grid. This created a magazine-style layout rather than a simple uniform grid, giving the gallery more visual variety.

To maintain consistency between images with different original dimensions, I used aspect-ratio together with object-fit: cover on the portfolio items. This ensured that the images maintained a consistent portrait shape without being distorted or stretched.

I also developed the hover interaction for each portfolio image. The *.portfolio_caption* was positioned as an absolutely placed overlay with a gradient background. By default, the caption was hidden using opacity: 0 and positioned slightly lower using a transform. The *:hover* pseudo-class and CSS transition properties were then used to smoothly fade and slide the caption into view when the user moves their cursor over an image. I also applied a subtle *scale()* transformation to the image during hover, making the gallery feel more interactive and dynamic.

Finally, I styled the closing call-to-action section using the same typography, spacing, and visual language established throughout the portfolio page. I also implemented a button hover effect that transitions from a bordered style to a filled style. This helped create a consistent visual identity across the entire page, from the gallery through to the final call-to-action.

Neepta Singh 606745

I implemented the CSS interactive elements for the About page and the Contact page. First, I applied the sticky position to the photographer's portrait to ensure it stays in frame while a viewer can scroll through the sections of the about page, lending a clean look and not overwhelming the viewer with displaying all the info at once, as well as making the site interactive by prompting the viewer to scroll. As a call to action, at the bottom of the About page I placed a button to contact the photographer, which changes colour when hovering the mouse over it, and links to the contact page when clicked. I also added a fade effect to the photographer's portrait when hovering over it and showing information about her. This was done by setting the opacity of the caption element to 0, and setting it to 1 when hovering the mouse over the picture, implementing translate to create a transition effect. For the contacts page, I made the send message button change colour when hovering over it, as well as the contact information change colour when hovering over them to show they would be links. I was also in charge of putting all the web pages together so I ensured that all the links were correct and navigated to the correct pages. I also ensured that the navigation banner, logo and footer were all formatted exactly the same across all the pages to ensure a uniform and smooth transition across the website. I also looked through the CSS file to reduce redundant code, as a challenge we faced with working on the pages separately and sending them to each other to complete meant that sometimes code got copied unnecessarily.

Taletso Mangoale 605941

On the HTML side, my main priority was implementing clean, semantic markup to ensure the site was both accessible and well-organized. Instead of relying on generic <div> tags, I structured our pages using semantic HTML5 elements like <header>, <nav>, <main>, <section>, and <footer>. For instance, I set up a consistent navigation bar across all pages inside the <nav> tags, ensuring proper nesting for form elements, headings, and main content blocks. This provided a logical content hierarchy that browsers and screen readers can easily parse.

On the CSS side, I took charge of the visual styling, layout architecture, and responsiveness. To achieve a modern, flexible layout, I utilized CSS Grid and Flexbox—using Flexbox for alignment within the navigation bar and form controls, and CSS Grid to structure the overall

page layouts and content sections. I also implemented a mobile-first approach using @media queries, ensuring the site smoothly adapts across mobile, tablet, and desktop viewports. To enhance user experience, I wrote custom CSS for typography, consistent color schemes, and interactive hover state transitions on buttons and links.

By combining strict semantic HTML with responsive CSS techniques, I helped deliver a static, fully responsive website that meets all our milestone structural requirements and performance criteria.

Would you like to tailor this further to mention specific CSS classes, specific form fields you built, or highlight any JavaScript additions from the optional extensions?